

DORM DASH

TEAM 13



INTRODUCING THE TEAM





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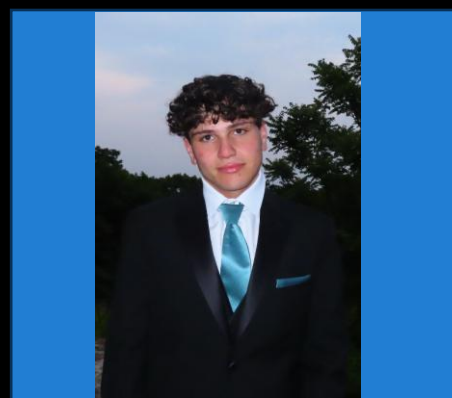
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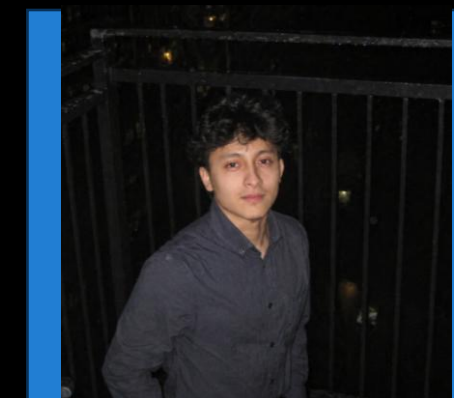
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OUR IDEA

DormDash is a monthly subscription-based dorm essentials delivery service designed to simplify everyday life for college students living on campus. The service provides customizable, budget-friendly boxes of snacks, cleaning supplies, and other everyday items for students without transportation.

INDUSTRY & COMPETITORS

DormDash operates within the expanding subscription-box and convenience goods market, where students value speed and simplicity. While competitors like Walmart, DoorDash, and Instacart offer delivery, they focus on broad consumer needs rather than the specific needs of dorm living. This gives DormDash a clear advantage by serving a segment with tailored, student-focused essentials.

MARKETING GOALS & STRATEGY

DormDash focuses on reaching students through high-impact channels. Instagram and TikTok ads drive traffic to the website and mobile app for quick sign-ups and customization. On campus, flyers, tables, and student events build visibility, supported by product launches through campus newspapers and local media. Partnerships with Rutgers ResLife build access to dorm communities. These efforts also allow expansion to other campuses as the company grows.

SUCCESS

DormDash is positioned to succeed because it solves a real problem for students living on campus who often run out of essentials and don't have the time, transportation, or budget to make frequent store trips. It gives them quick, affordable access to the small, everyday items they need, delivered right to their dorm. Students value convenience, and DormDash is driven to meet that need.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

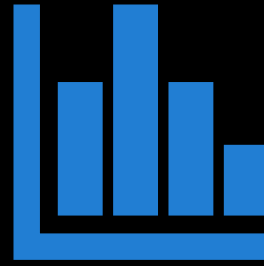




Before DormDash



After DormDash



SITUATION ANALYSIS

Product Concept: DormDash is the subscription delivery platform that gives students at Rutgers monthly delivery subscription service that allows students with essentials given straight to the residence halls.

Customer Need: Small amounts of transportation to different areas, Busy schedules, Low amount of money students have, The need for essentials as the semester continues , The ability to save time

Common Products Needed: Food, Toiletries, Cleaning supplies, School supplies

Problems with Current Options: Places like Amazon and Walmart are not student served (more expensive) , Bulk purchases can not even fit in a dorm room , Delivery is always high or needs a minimum order requirement, No personalization to what specifically one may want

How DormDash Solves the Need: It provides a monthly delivery directly to each dorm building , It's super affordable (\$20-\$25 per month), Smaller items that are better for dorm sizing, Customized boxes based off students' preferences, Saves students so much time and energy

Why It Has Opportunity: There is a large number of students in the college market, The demand for convenience stores are super high, There are little competitors in terms of dorm residents, There is a repeat purchase in terms of other subscriptions



INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

Industry: Subscription box and student convenience goods market

Market size

- \$87 Billion total college spending yearly (National Retail Federation, 2024)
 - includes: clothing, toiletries, school supplies, electronics, furniture
~ \$1,200 per student
- Core relevant categories (food, personal care, school supplies) generates around \$25B annually
 - Around 92% of groceries (49% of personal care items are purchased throughout the school year as recurring costs (CollegeInc, 2024)
- Adjusting for items that may be one-time purchases or unsuitable for subscription purposes
 - Total market size: **\$3.4–5.7 billion** annually in the U.S.

Growth trends

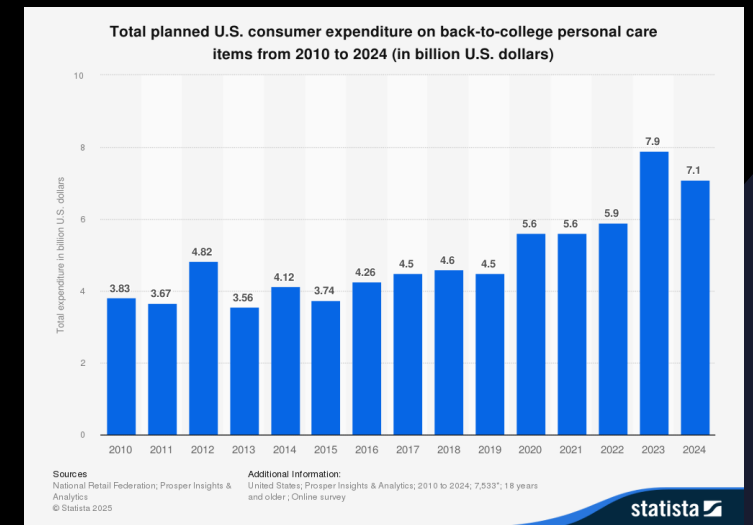
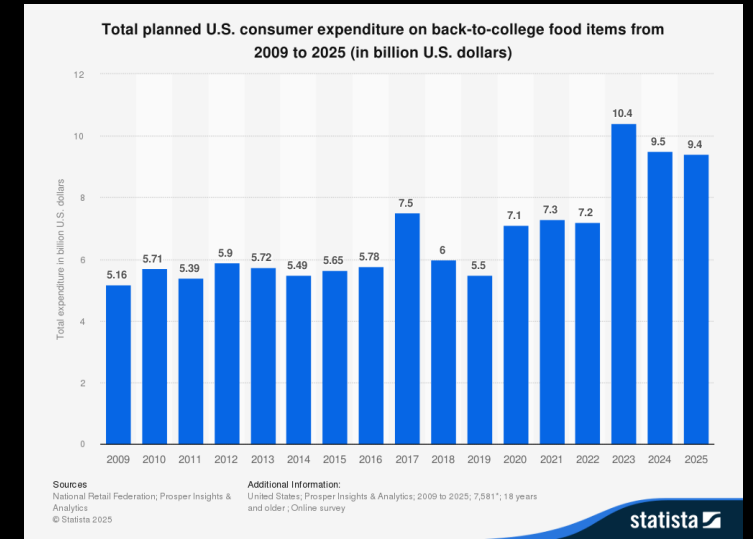
- College spending has steadily increased over the past 20+ years
 - \$52B in 2007 compared to 87B reported in 2024 (NRF)
 - Also shown visually on graphs to the right (Statista, 2024)

Margin/trends

- Typical industry profit margin range: 20-50% (Gitnux, 2026)
- Rising demand for:
 - Convenience and life-specific products

Ease of entry: Moderate

- Challenges
 - High competition from major retailers: Walmart, Target
 - Shipping costs
- Advantages
 - Convenience, campus-focused marketing, niche market
 - Low barrier to entry: can launch with basic e-commerce tools



DormDash operates within a market filled with large players

However, its specification of dorm residents offers differentiation

Competitor Profiles (Direct):

- Amazon (Prime Delivery)
- Instacart
- Walmart Delivery

Competitor Profiles (Indirect):

- DoorDash / Uber Eats
- On and off campus retail stores

Product/Service Comparison:

- DormDash: Specific curated packages, small packaging, college students based
- Amazon/Walmart: Bulk repurchasing, wide variety
- Instacart: Flexible selection, grocery store specialized, budget friendly



instacart



COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS



COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

Pricing Strategy:

- DormDash: Tiered subscription model (\$20/\$25 a month)
- Amazon: Subscription (prime) + per -item pricing
- Walmart: Affordable, membership option (Walmart+) free delivery
- Instacart: Delivery fees + service fees + tips

Marketing & Positioning:

- DormDash USP: "Hand-picked dorm necessities monthly"
- Amazon USP: "Everything you need, fast"
- Walmart USP: "Everyday low prices"
- Instacart USP: "Groceries delivered in as fast as 1 hour"

DormDash SWOT:

- Strengths: Niche target, subscription convenience, affordable
- Weaknesses: Smaller scale, high costs, high market competition
- Opportunities: Expansion to other college campuses, partner with colleges
- Threats: Large competitor pool, rising delivery cost, changing student preferences



ENVIRONMENTAL ANALYSIS



Key Takeaways

- Customer Base & Loyalty
- Fluctuating Demands
- Amazon's Partnership Program
- Risk of High Costs
- Increasing Shortage In Drivers

Strengths • Loyal Customers • Ecological Advantages • Increased Sales & Revenue	Weaknesses • Increased Fuel Costs • High Delivery Cost • Risk of Damaged Goods
Opportunities • High Demand • Environmental Impact • Amazon's Delivery Service Partner Program	Threats • Driver shortages • Intense Competition • Changing Market Demands

TARGET AUDIENCE

Demographic Segmentation:

Age: 18-22 years old

Education: Undergraduate college students (especially first-year/out of state students/students with no car)

Income: low-moderate income

Occupation: Student

Psychographic Segmentation:

- Convenience-driven students who value organization and time-saving solutions
- Students who are experiencing independence for the first time

Geographic Segmentation:

- Students living on U.S. college campuses, especially
 - o Suburban / rural campuses with limited nearby market availability
 - o On-campus housing communities

Behavioral Segmentation:

- Students who regularly purchase essentials (cleaning, food, school supplies)
- Prefer online shopping over in-store
- Open to signing up for subscriptions that automatically deliver to them

TARGET AUDIENCE



"The Overwhelmed Freshman"

- First-year student living in a dorm
- Adjusting to independence for the first time
- No transportation to stores
- Limited storage space
- Frequently forgets essentials
 - o Pre-curated essentials kits removes decision fatigue
 - o Monthly delivery eliminates store trips



"The Out-Of-State Student"

- Lives in on-campus dorm
- Hundreds of miles away from home
- Cannot easily bring everything from home
- Shipping items to dorms is stressful/unreliable
 - o Monthly deliveries eliminate store trips/need for transportation
 - o Customizable to student needs



"The Busy Student"

- Involved in clubs, sports, work
- Packed daily schedule
- Academically driven
- No time for errands
- Frequently runs out of supplies unexpectedly
 - o Automatic recurring deliveries reduce mental load
 - o Prevents last-minute stressed purchasing

MARKETING OBJECTIVES



Brand Awareness

- **Social Media Growth:** Increase social media following to 10,000 followers within 6 months by posting 5 times per week
- **Campus Awareness:** Achieve 15% brand awareness within 9 months through tabling, flyers, and ambassador programs.

Market Share Targets

- **Campus-Specific Penetration Goal:** Reach 10% adoption in 2 high-density campuses (ex. College Ave & Livingston) within 1 academic year.
- **Freshman Dorm Penetration:** Capture 8% of on-campus freshmen at Rutgers–New Brunswick within 12 months



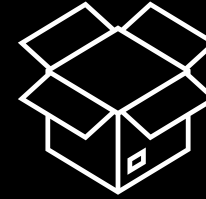
Sales/Revenue Goals

- **Semester-Based Revenue Target:** Generate \$50,000 in total revenue during the fall semester by averaging 600 subscribers paying \$20/month.
- **Tiered Pricing Revenue Mix:** Introduce 2 subscription tiers (Basic \$20, Premium \$25) and achieve a revenue mix where 20% of users choose Premium within 1 year.

MARKETING MIX



1. PRODUCT



VALUE PROP

“DormDash makes dorm life easier by delivering affordable, customizable monthly essentials directly to students who don’t have the time, transportation, or budget to shop off-campus.”



USP

“Hand-picked dorm necessities monthly.”



WHY IT'S BETTER

Only dorm essentials delivery service that offers boxes customizable to student needs

Competitors sell full-size or fixed boxes

Cheaper, more convenient, built specifically for students living on campus



CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE

Stress-free — students feel stocked each month.

Convenience — essentials delivered right to the dorm

Personalized care — boxes feel tailored to needs

Mini-quantity affordability — students save money by getting only what they need



PRODUCT ASPECTS

Consistent delivery

Simple, themed packaging

Option to customize or swap items

Transparent pricing

Reliable customer support for quick fixes, replacements, or item requests





2. PLACE



DISTRIBUTION

- Direct-to-consumer (DTC) subscription model
- Orders placed through website and mobile app
- Monthly delivery directly to dorm buildings



CHANNEL

- Fully online (no physical retail presence)
- Single-channel → transitioning to multi-channel (app + web + campus partnerships)



GEOGRAPHIC FOCUS

Initial launch: Rutgers–New Brunswick (College Ave & Livingston campuses)

Expansion to additional high-density college campuses over time



WHY?

- Eliminates need for students to travel off-campus
- Lower operational costs vs. physical storefronts
- Fast, scalable model across multiple campuses
- Supports convenience-focused value proposition

3. PRICING



PRICING MODEL

Subscription-based pricing (monthly recurring revenue)

Tiered pricing structure:

- Basic Plan: \$20/month
- Premium Plan: \$25/month (more items + customization)



COMPETITION

Cheaper than frequent small purchases via Amazon/Target delivery

More flexible than fixed subscription boxes (customization option)

Designed specifically for dorm needs vs. general consumer packages



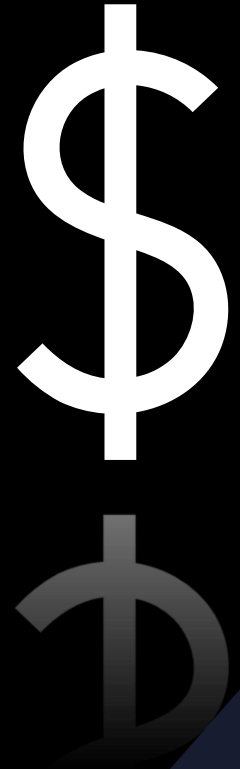
PROMOTIONS

First-month discount for new subscribers

Referral incentives (discounts for inviting friends)

Seasonal/semester promotions (back-to-school, finals week boxes)

Bundle deals for longer subscription commitments





4. PROMOTION



Targeted social media campaigns on Instagram and TikTok, main website, and mobile app for sign-ups, customization, and account management



Social media advertising, online ads, and flyers around campus to increase product visibility and increase customer base



PR and media outreach: Share student feedback, and product launches with campus newspapers and local media to build awareness and credibility



Campus partnerships: Collaborate with Rutgers residence life and student organizations to promote DormDash through events and orientation programs



Social media serves as primary channel where students discover new products, compare options, and make purchase decisions

EVALUATION & CONTROL



How will we monitor the plan?

- Track monthly subscriptions, cancellations, and customer feedback
- Review website & social media analytics
- Monitor delivery performance and customer service issues

What KPI's will we measure?

- Sales, monthly subscriptions, revenue per month
- Customer lifetime value, social engagement, website traffic
- Campus reach, on-time delivery rate, customer service response time

How often will we review?

- Weekly: web traffic, social engagement
- Monthly: sales, subscription growth
- Quarterly: pricing strategy, product mix

If the plan is on target:

- Increase investment in top-performing channels
- Expand preset boxes or seasonal options
- Introduce loyalty perks
- Scale campus partnerships and events

If the plan is off target:

- Adjust promotional strategy (more targeted ads?)
- Offer limited-time discounts to boost sign-ups
- Revise box contents based on feedback

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